

MERMAID • BOTH FENCE CHARACTERS

A tilde fence draws its diagram

CommonMark fences with backticks **or** tildes, and Markdown treats the two as the same thing. The live preview always did. The export did not — until this deck.

What was wrong, and where

TILDE FENCES · A ~~~MERMAID BLOCK DRAWS ITS DIAGRAM ON BOTH PATHS

The CLI substituted an SVG for a backtick fence and nothing else, so a tilde fence printed as **raw source** in the PDF.

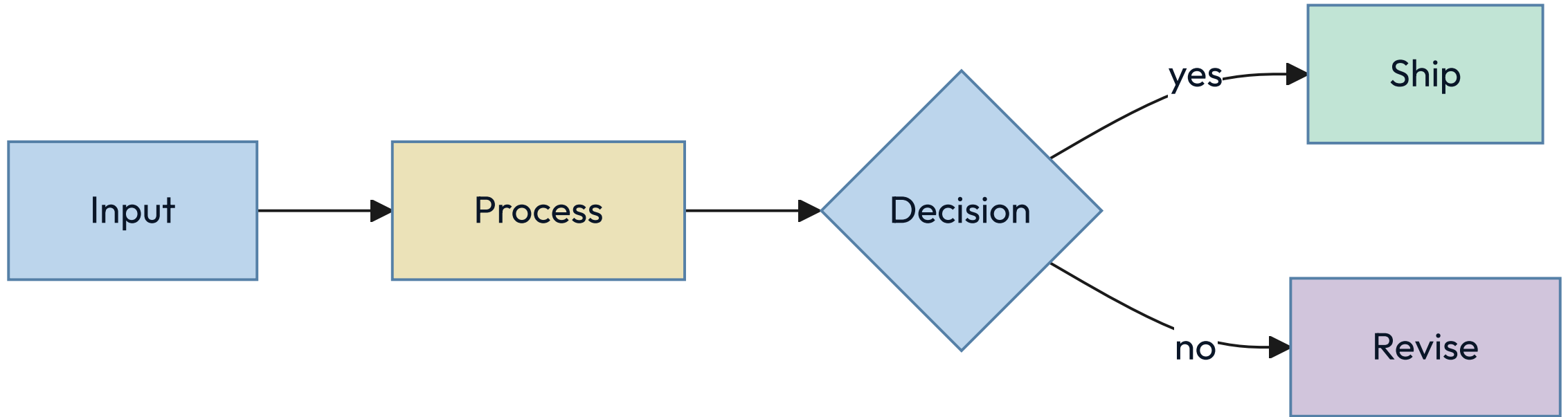
The author could not see it coming: the preview they wrote in renders both. The next two slides are one diagram, written two ways.

KEY INSIGHT

markdown-it emits `class="language-mermaid"` for either fence, and the runtime keys on that class.

A backtick fence.

TILDE FENCES • A ~~~MERMAID BLOCK DRAWS ITS DIAGRAM ON BOTH PATHS

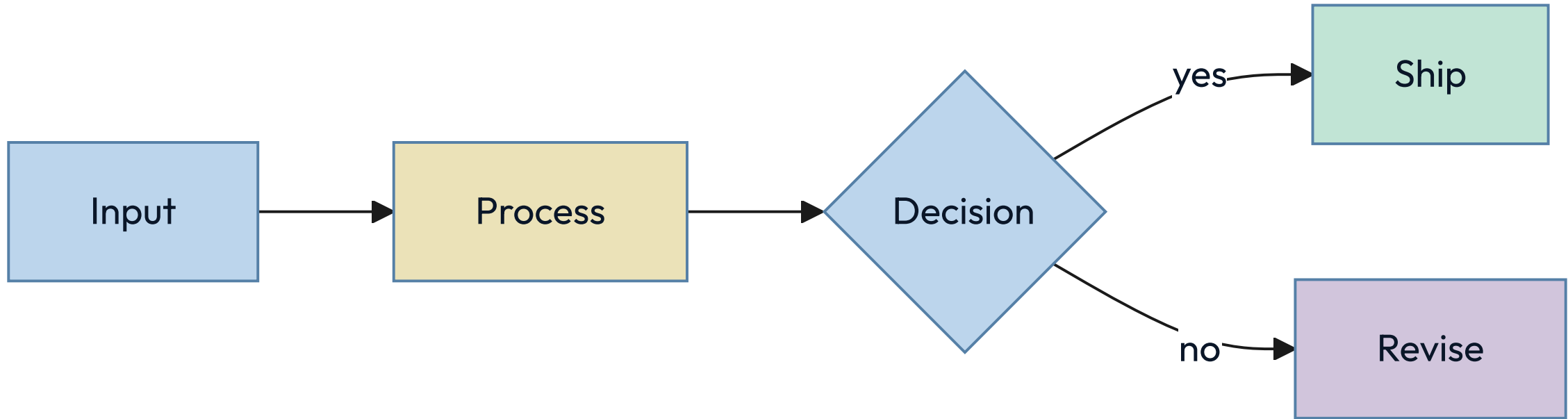


KEY INSIGHT

The form every deck in this repo already uses.

A tilde fence.

TILDE FENCES · A ~~~MERMAID BLOCK DRAWS ITS DIAGRAM ON BOTH PATHS



KEY INSIGHT

Identical bytes on the slide. Before this change, this page printed five lines of Mermaid source.

One walker, and what it is allowed to move.

TILDE FENCES · A ~~~MERMAID BLOCK DRAWS ITS DIAGRAM ON BOTH PATHS

Both callers read it

The CLI's substitution, and the narrator. Widen one alone and the voice cannot read the diagram.

It walks lines, not a regex

A closer may outrun its opener; a fence inside a fence is a sample. A regex got both wrong.

No deck's bytes moved

Across 1387 tracked files, three docs changed — each already substituting its own example.